Megathon X: Singularity

Title Sponsor

LLOYDS BANK

In association with

Qualcomm, Bhashini & Vanguard

Terms & Conditions

Organized by

E-Cell, IIIT Hyderabad

Meet. Ideate. Hack.

1. Eligibility

- Only students currently enrolled in undergraduate, postgraduate, or doctoral programs (such as B.Tech, M.Tech, MS, or PhD or equivalent degrees) at colleges or universities recognized by the UGC, AICTE, or a state/central education board in India are eligible to participate.
- Each participant must present a valid college-issued student ID card with their name, photograph, date of issue and date of expiry clearly visible (hard or soft copy, both accepted).
- Invalid or fake IDs will lead to disqualification without refund.
- International students enrolled in recognized Indian institutions are eligible.
- All individuals who have purchased a valid ticket are eligible for participation; there will be no prior shortlisting or elimination round.
- Inter-college teams are permitted.

2. Participation

- Participants may register individually or in teams.
- Teams may consist of up to five (5) members, and every member must meet the eligibility criteria.
- All team members must be registered participants with valid tickets obtained through Konfhub mail.
- After the problem statements are announced, a form will be circulated for problem statement allocation. Allocation will be determined using an internal algorithm designed to ensure fair and balanced distribution across teams and problem statements.
- No changes to team composition (members or names) will be permitted after **9th October 2026, 11:59 PM**.
- Once a problem statement has been allocated, no changes to the allocation will be entertained.
- The hackathon will be conducted entirely offline. No hybrid or online participation is permitted.

3. Ticketing

- Each participant must present their ticket at on-site registration. Tickets may be bought individually or as a group.
- Tickets are non-transferable and cannot be resold.
- Refund requests must be emailed to `ecell@iiit.ac.in`, and are refunded according to when they are received:
  - By **6:00 PM on 26th September 2026**: full refund.
  - After 6:00 PM on 26th September and by **11:59 PM on 2nd October 2026**: 50% refund.

  - After 11:59 PM on 2nd October 2026: no refund.

- Disputes relating to registration or ticketing may be raised by email to `ecell@iiit.ac.in` and will be handled as set out in Section 20.
- In case of event cancellation, refund policies will be communicated by organizers at that time.
- A special coupon code is available only for IIIT Hyderabad participants during online registration.
- On-spot registrations will be available for both IIITH and non-IIITH participants. No special discounts apply.
- The fee is charged **per participant**, not per team.

4. Check-in & Attendance

- Participants must check in at the venue before the official start time (reporting and start time will be intimated later).
- Late entry and re-entry during the event are subject to security checks and organizer approval.
- Overnight stay is mandatory as part of the hackathon. Exemptions may be considered on a case-by-case basis with prior organizer approval.
- Basic facilities (food, seating arrangements, charging points, etc.) will be provided.
- Access restrictions: Non-IIIT participants are not permitted to enter institute workspaces or laboratories, Vindhya, T-Hub or KRB lab spaces. They may only use designated rooms in the Himalaya Block for the duration of the event.
- A IIIT Hyderabad route map will be shared with participants closer to the event to guide movement within the campus.

5. Hardware & Equipment

- Participants must bring their own laptops and devices.
- Specialized hardware required for problem statements will be provided if mentioned in advance by sponsors/organizers.
- Participants must bear the cost of repair or replacement for any damage caused to provided hardware.
- Borrowing/sharing equipment between teams is allowed at their own risk; organizers are not responsible.

6. Internet & Infrastructure

- Wi-Fi will be provided at the venue.
- Any attempt to hack into networks, devices, or infrastructure will result in disqualification.

- Use of external servers/cloud platforms is permitted unless restricted by the problem statement.

7. Usage of Coding Tools

- No restrictions on programming languages, stacks, or libraries unless specified.
- AI tools, including chatbots and LLMs, are permitted unless explicitly restricted.

8. Submission Policy

- Each team will be given a private GitHub repository in the **IIIT-ECell** GitHub organization. All submissions must be made through this repository; teams must not create their own repositories for submission.
- Every participant must have a GitHub account, submit their GitHub username to the organizers when asked, and accept the invitation to their team's repository. All team members must have joined their team's repository by the **M1 deadline (10:00 PM, 10th October 2026)**. Teams are responsible for ensuring this.
- Submissions are made in three stages:
  - **M1 (Approach): 10:00 PM, 10th October 2026:** A PDF describing the team's high-level idea, abstract, approach, and/or proposed architecture. The exact details of the approach are not required, just a high level approach/pipeline/idea, along with a rough testing mechanism outlining the planned testing methodologies. Page limit: 2 pages.
  - **M2 (Mid-submission): 4:00 AM, 11th October 2026:** (i) A progress report outlining details such as approach, experiments run so far, and progress on testing. Page limit: 2 pages. (ii) A code push, containing all the scripts built so far.
  - **Final submission: 11:00 AM, 11th October 2026:**
    - Full solution code in the repository, along with:
      - `README.md` with compilation and execution instructions only (don't explain the solution/approach here),
      - a `LICENSE` file (see Section 11).
    - A zip archive of the code, submitted through the submission form as a backup.
    - A final report (PDF): explaining the solution, the approach, features, etc. page-limit: 3.
    - A demo video: recording of the solution built, and a voiceover explaining the solution. Video-length should not exceed 4 min.
  - **Slides submission: 11:30 AM, 11th October 2026:** Presentation slides.
- The demo video must be submitted as **publicly accessible** Google Drive links. Links that cannot be opened by the judges will be treated as missing submissions.
- Exact specifications for the M1 PDF and the final report, along with where each file must be placed, will be released during the event.
- At each deadline, organizers will record the latest commit on the default branch (`main`) of every repository. Only the recorded commit will be evaluated; anything pushed after

the deadline will be ignored. Commit timestamps set on participants' machines are not considered.

- Teams are responsible for keeping the default branch (`main`) in a working state. If the recorded commit is broken, incomplete, or missing work because of a force-push, deleted branch, or similar action by any team member, it will still be evaluated as recorded; organizers will not restore or substitute earlier or later commits.
- After the final submission deadline, all repositories will be archived and become read-only. Teams will retain read access.
- Repositories are **private** and will remain private. Access for judges, mentors, and sponsors is managed by the organizers.
- Large datasets, model checkpoints/weights, and other large files must **not** be pushed to the repository. Where needed, they must be hosted externally and linked in `README.md`. GitHub also rejects any single file larger than 100 MB.
- A live deployment is not required. Judging is based on the repository and in-person demonstration.
- No or late **mid-submissions** (M1 or M2) will result in direct disqualification.
- No or late **final submissions** will not be considered for any further rounds of evaluation.

9. Code of Conduct

- Participants must respect fellow participants, mentors, judges, and organizers.
- Harassment, abusive behavior, or cheating will result in disqualification.
- Plagiarism or use of pre-built solutions without acknowledgment is prohibited; see Section 10.
- Use of alcohol, drugs, or prohibited substances is strictly forbidden.
- Any misconduct or violation of the Code of Conduct must be reported immediately to the organizers via the designated helpdesk or helpline numbers (shared through QR codes at the venue). During the event, issues may also be raised through the official Discord server.

10. Originality & Plagiarism

- A submission is original only if it was built by the team during the **hackathon window** — from the release of the problem statements to the final submission deadline. Originality is judged by when and by whom the work was created, not by how much an existing project has been changed.
- Third-party libraries, frameworks, APIs, models, datasets, and boilerplate may be used if licensed correctly and credited in `README.md`. AI assistance is permitted; see Section 7.
- Forks, clones, rebrands, ports, and derivatives of existing projects may not be submitted as a team's solution. The extent of modification is not a defence.
- No project or codebase that existed before the problem statements were released may be submitted, including a team's or member's own earlier work and work from a course, internship, or employer.

- An existing project may be used as a dependency, but may not be the solution. If it supplies the core functionality the problem statement asks for, the submission is not original.
- A team may reuse its own general-purpose utility code or design assets if disclosed in `README.md` and not the substance of the solution.
- Repositories must preserve full commit history and show incremental development. Squashed or imported history, or a first commit containing a substantially complete solution, will be treated as evidence of a pre-existing codebase.
- Organizers may use similarity-detection tools, commit-metadata analysis, and live questioning, and may require a team to explain or reproduce any part of its submission. Refusal is grounds for disqualification.
- Suspected violations may be reported through the helpdesk or the official Discord server during the event, or by email to `ecell@iiit.ac.in` afterwards.
- A violation established during the event results in disqualification of the entire team, without refund.
- If a violation surfaces after results are announced, organizers may, within **90 days**, revoke the team's award, certificates, and prize money, reclaim prize money already paid, reassign the award to the next-ranked team, and inform the sponsor. The team will be given seven (7) days to respond before any such action is taken.

11. Intellectual Property

- All code and related material submitted during the hackathon must include a license file. The default license shall be the **MIT License**.
- Participants retain full ownership of the intellectual property they create.
- By submitting their work, participants grant the sponsor of the problem statement a **perpetual, royalty-free, non-exclusive license** to use, modify, distribute, and build upon the submitted solution for research, development, or commercial purposes.
- This license does not restrict participants from reusing, modifying, or commercializing their work independently.
- Judges and organizers must be given full access to the code and related materials for evaluation purposes only.
- Any separate agreements or arrangements between participants and sponsors beyond the hackathon are strictly between them; the organizers are not involved or liable.
- Projects must not infringe on third-party intellectual property rights. Submissions must comply with the **MIT License** and ensure compatibility with its permissive terms.

12. Evaluation

- Evaluation will be conducted in three rounds:

- **R0:** Online double-blind review of final submissions, beginning at 11:00 AM on 11th October 2026. The evaluation will check if the submitted solution meets basic requirements. The criteria will not be publicly released. Please ensure you comply with submission policy detailed in section 8.
- **R1:** In-person evaluation by sponsors of the respective problem statements. The evaluation criteria for this round will be determined solely at the discretion of the sponsor. Organizers shall not be held responsible for any modifications or decisions made by sponsors during this round. The **top 3 teams** from each problem statement will advance to R2.
- **R2:** Final pitching round for the 3 teams from each problem statement, before a panel of sponsors and independent judges. The R2 panel will select **one (1) winner** for each problem statement; the other two (2) teams will be the **runners-up**. Only an overview of the expectations for R2 will be shared publicly; detailed evaluation criteria will remain confidential.

- Organizers reserve the right to adjust awards if there is a significant imbalance.

13. Prizes

- Each problem statement will have one (1) winner and two (2) runners-up.
- Prizes will consist of cash awards and winning certificates.
- The prize amount may vary across different problem statements, depending on the sponsoring organization's allocation and discretion.
- Allocation of problem statements will be based on the internal algorithm, irrespective of the prize money associated with each statement. No requests for reallocation or changes in problem statements based on prize value will be entertained under any circumstances.
- All participants will receive stickers, a T-shirt, a participation certificate, a notebook, and a pen.
- All prizes are subject to applicable taxes and awarded per team unless otherwise specified by the sponsor.
- Organizers are not responsible for additional perks, benefits, or prize components promised or offered by sponsors.
- All awards are subject to the originality requirements in Section 10 and may be revoked, and prize money reclaimed, in accordance with that section.

14. Travel & Accommodation

- Participants must arrange their own travel.
- Accommodation is not provided by default. Outstation participants must make arrangements unless otherwise communicated.
- Participants will not be provided accommodation at any time before or after the hackathon.

15. Food & Facilities

- Dinner will be provided on 10th October 2026.
- Breakfast and lunch will be provided on 11th October 2026.
- Only vegetarian food will be served.
- Participants with allergies or specific dietary preferences must inform organizers in advance at `ecell@iiit.ac.in`.
- Paid food stalls will be available during the hackathon.
- Outside food delivery may be restricted by venue policies.

16. Liability, Safety & Emergency

- Participants are responsible for their belongings.
- Participants are liable for any damage they cause to property at the venue.
- Organizers are not liable for accidents, injuries, or damages.
- Basic first aid and medical support will be available.
- In emergencies, organizers will assist with hospital care but costs must be borne by participants.
- Pre-existing medical conditions must be disclosed.
- Help QR codes with helpline numbers will be displayed at the venue. Pre-event queries can be directed via the official website.

17. Changes to Event Format

- Organizers reserve the unconditional right to modify, postpone, or cancel any part of the hackathon, including but not limited to its structure, rules, schedule, evaluation process, prize distribution, or overall format at any point in time, without prior notice, if deemed necessary due to technical, logistical, legal, or other unforeseen circumstances. All such decisions by the organizers shall be final and binding.
- Participants will be notified of any major updates through official channels such as email and social media prior to the event, where possible.
- During the event, announcements will be communicated via the official Discord server and on-site notifications.
- Organizers shall not be held liable for delays, modifications, or cancellations arising from force majeure events or circumstances beyond their reasonable control.

18. Media Consent

- By attending, participants consent to being photographed, filmed, or recorded.
- Organizers may use such media for promotional purposes.

- A link to the photo folder will be shared after the event.

19. Disqualification

- Organizers reserve the right to remove any participant or team found violating these Terms and Conditions.
- Causes for disqualification include, but are not limited to:
  - Providing invalid or fake identification.
  - Harassment, abusive behavior, or violation of the Code of Conduct.
  - Cheating, or any breach of the originality requirements in Section 10.
  - Tampering with problem statement allocation or submission process.
  - Attempting to hack venue infrastructure, networks, or other participants' devices.
  - Use of alcohol, drugs, or prohibited substances during the event.
  - Refusal to comply with organizer or security instructions.

20. Dispute Resolution

- Any disputes arising during registration, participation, evaluation, or prize distribution will be resolved solely by the organizing team.
- During the event, disputes can be raised through the helpdesk, helpline numbers (via QR codes at the venue), or through the official Discord server.
- All decisions made by the organizers are final and binding, with no appeal process.

21. Data Privacy

- Participant data collected during registration will be used strictly for event management and communication purposes.
- Data will not be sold or shared with unrelated third parties.
- Sponsors will receive access to limited participant data (e.g., name, email, college, year of study) solely for event-related communication.
- By registering, participants consent to this usage of their data.

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